

SKI TV - NATIONAL SNOW SHOW - JEREMY ROSE INTERVIEW - WWW.POWDERMAD.COM

Ski TV here at the National Snow Show in Birmingham, NEC and I have my special guest in the studio. It's Gem Rhodes from powdermad.com and Gem, welcome to the show. Thanks Geoff, that's brilliant.

It's great to be here. Brilliant to see you. Now I was having a chat with you last night at the drink session here and you were telling me about all the great things that Powder Mad offers.

You've got Heli Ski, you've got Tours, tell us about a few of things Powder Mad offers. Yeah, sure. I mean we have a variety of different things from ski touring in the Alps, in the French Alps, to cat skiing in the Ukraine.

We go out of Dragobrat in the Ukraine, but we've even got Heli trips going on in Nepal. We're doing some heli stuff from the South Anapurna out of Pokhara, but we're also doing Kamchatka this year as well, and if you don't know where Kamchatka is it's opposite Alaska. You've got Alaska and you've got the Bering Sea, and we've got a lodge there where we're going to be doing some heli skiing there too.

We're also operating out of Sochi as well, and we've got a great trip, absolutely super trip actually, out of Georgia, which we're looking forward to incredibly. We want to see you there too Geoff. We want to get out there with a couple of UK celebrities, come out and see you guys.

And now Gem Roads from PowerToMad.com, I mean let's zero in on one, Georgia. A lot of people have never been there, they don't know what it's all about, tell us a bit about it. Okay, well this is a different world, you know, and we were talking about a country that it's off the Black Sea.

When you're out there skiing you feel like you're a pioneer as far as the ski world is, and you are, you know, because not many people are out there, especially Europeans. So you might be walking down the little village there, and there'll be chickens running around, kids running around, etcetera, but then we're going to go very sophisticated and we're going to go heli skiing, and we're skiing some gigantic peaks out there. Around us are peaks of up to 5,000 metres, and some serious powder, some serious skiing.

It's great fun, if you like culture and you like skiing, you know, and you like that kind of mix of things, that's what you get in, essentially. It's unbelievable, I've heard all the stories, but it's just incredible experience out there, isn't it? And what about the other places, Sochi sounds interesting too, I mean it's been on the map since the Olympics, but yeah, amazing. I think the one place I'd like to sort of focus on is one area that people don't know of, it's the Ukraine, and we're skiing in an old ski village called Dragobrat, it's a very interesting place to get to, we have to take an old Russian military 4x4 truck to get up to the village, and this truck runs like a bus, up and down, but it's the only way up there, because there's no man-made road.

Once we're up there, we're cat skiing, so we're in a converted peace spasher, and we'll be accessing the mountains around there, it's a lot of fun as well, we normally have a party of about 15 of us, and we do have a little party too, Jeff. Just the journey up there, forget the skiing, just the journey getting there must be a whole experience within itself. Oh yeah, I mean you truly feel like a pioneer, you know, and once you arrive there, and we get you booked into the hotel, the hotel staff are really impressed that, you know, we've got some Europeans experiencing their mountains, so it's great, and they want to talk to you, they want to get to know you, and they want to give you a vodka now and again as well, yeah.

The hospitality must be incredible. Oh certainly, yeah, absolutely, yeah, it's what I call off the clock, yeah. That hospitality is part of the culture of these people, isn't it? Just to be super friendly, super nice to foreign people.

Yeah, I mean they're really impressed, you know, we're going out to some very odd locations that, you know, don't normally see tourism, so they are super impressed that you're there to experience what they've got and for them to show you what they've got, you know, and it's great, and they love it, and they, you know, they may not speak great English, but, you know, we do get by and there's a lot of hand signaling and, you know, we get by. And not to mention the value for money, it must be absolutely incredible there. Oh yeah, I mean, you know, if you're in Ukraine, a beer is ATP, you know.

For a pint. For a pint, yeah, yeah. It's a decent pint as well, yeah, yeah.

And, yeah, I mean, that particular trip, we put everything together for the clients for £1,500, and that includes all the food, transfers, and the guides. We have two guides per trip, and we, you know, we have a super time, you know. Now, I know that the heli-ski experience is just amazing, and you use local helicopters, local pilots, they all know the area very, very well.

Absolutely, yeah. I mean, that's kind of crucial, really. So, if we're in Kamchatka, for example, we need local guys, you know, to fly the... We use MI-8s, the big helicopters out there.

It takes two pilots. You get 20 guys on one of these. That's a serious machine.

It's a serious machine, yeah. It's very robust, yeah. It's like the old Soviet Army type thing.

It's a big experience to go on one of those things, yeah. Yeah, I mean, these things are massive, you know, are massively powerful. And we always have very highly qualified guides that accompany the team.

So, we use a guide that we take with us, a high mountain guide, but we also use a local guide, because it's absolutely critical that we have the safety of everybody as a foremost, you know, priority, let's say. How can we find you on the website, social media? Yeah, go to powdermad.com. It's as simple as that. And join us, join the tribe.

There is a join the tribe page. If you register your details on there, you become a member of that club. And when we've got different trips that are coming up, we'll send it out and we'll remind you.

We offer, as a member as well, we offer discounts on various things as well. Yeah. Great.

Well, thanks very much for coming into Ski TV Studio, Mr. Rhodes. And, guys, powdermad.com. Highly recommended by Ski TV. It's a great service and let's give a wave to all the Ski TV fans out there, mate.

And take it easy and check out the guys, something very different and you'll never regret it. See ya. Thank you.